Species A group of organisms capable of exchanging genes with one another through reproduction.

Stochasticity Unpredictable fluctuations in environmental conditions that affect populations and ecological processes.

Succession The process by which a biological community evolves over time, from a few simple species to a complex ecosystem, through species' impact on the environment.

Taxonomy The science of naming and classifying different organisms.

Tectonic plates Pieces of Earth's crust and uppermost mantle that gradually shift over time, causing seafloor spreading, continental drift, and mountains, rift valleys, volcanoes, and earthquakes at plate boundaries.

Thermoregulation The internal processes that occur within an organism to ensure it maintains a stable temperature, a function that is crucial for survival.

Transmutation The process of evolutionary divergence by which one species transforms into an entirely new one.

Trophic cascade The impact that the removal of a trophic level of a food chain with at least three levels has on the wider ecosystem as a whole.

Trophic level The place of an organism within an ecosystem's hierarchy; organisms that are on the same level of the food chain are on the same trophic level.

Tropics The region of Earth that surrounds the equator, between the lines of the Tropic of Cancer and the Tropic of Capricorn, and does not experience the same seasonal changes as the rest of Earth.

Urbanization The process which occurs when rural areas are built upon intensively, almost always with negative consequences for the natural environment.